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Senior Backend Engineer (Go/PHP) · AI/LLM Product Engineer
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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 13 years on high-traffic web products, most recently at VK Video and Skyeng; five of them as a team lead and tech lead. Moved to Go as my main language after years of PHP.

Work with coding agents daily and build the tooling around them: agent instructions, skills, hooks, MCP, spec-driven workflow (OpenSpec). Ship LLM features and measure whether they work; latest project: an LLM ad-segment detector for my own browser extension with ~11k weekly active users, scored by a public eval harness. Looking for a hands-on senior engineering role, ideally building products around LLMs.

EXPERIENCE

VK · VK Video, creator platform — Team Lead · May 2024 – Sep 2026

Led the backend of two product teams in the creator area (~7 engineers) of VK Video, a platform with 40M+ daily users and ~3B video views a day (2025): content creation (upload, publish, manage videos) and the creator channel (channel page, customization, subscriptions). Clients: iOS, Android, web, TV, open API.

- Owned features from design to production; e.g. "comment as a channel": designed and built the backend; A/B result: +14% creators commenting on web and +23% comments per creator on Android.
- Led the team's part of the KPHP → Go migration: designed the creator-channel service, drove it through architecture review, and worked on the migration alongside the team; by the end most of the team's API methods ran in Go.
- Owned the area's product stability: every feature shipped behind toggles with a gradual rollout and an A/B test on product metrics (watch time, subscriptions, creator retention) before full launch; took part in incident response.
- Over the period, the platform's creator base grew about 6x, video uploads 4.6x and total watch time 2.1x in 2025 alone. In the area our two teams owned, creator MAU grew 20–107% every half-year, channel subscriptions x3.2 and upload-to-publish conversion +7 pp in H2 2025.
- Ran cross-team planning and coordination, set up delivery processes (per-epic PRDs, early decomposition), handled hiring and performance reviews; delivery predictability ~92%.

Skyeng — Team Lead, internal automation · May 2023 – May 2024

- Led the internal-automation team (~7 engineers): all shared internal tools and integrations for a fully remote company of ~1,400 employees.
- Owned the CMDB (PHP): single source of truth for users, teams, services and servers; permissions and per-team infrastructure costs.
- Owned the company messenger (Go): operations, plugins, integrations and internal bots; ran two company-wide migrations (Slack → Mattermost → TiMe).
- Owned Jira and Confluence (Groovy/ScriptRunner): rollout, performance tuning, monitoring and administration; built automations on top of them for other teams.

VK · VK Video — Senior Backend Developer (PHP/KPHP) · Jun 2022 – Apr 2023

- Built and optimized core backend features for video, clips and live streams at ~2B daily views.

Skyeng — three roles · Nov 2018 – Apr 2022

- **Senior Backend Developer, Skysmart** (2020–2022): launched several products under tight deadlines; designed their new backend architecture.
- **Unit Lead, Platform unit** (2019–2020): led 8 platform teams through their team leads; introduced SLA/SLO/SLI across all 8 teams; hired 3 team leads.
- **Team Lead, Billing team** (2018–2019): owned payments, balances and teacher payouts; staffed the team with developers, QA and analysts.

Earlier · 2013 – 2018

- **Melon Fashion Group — Backend Developer (PHP)** (2017–2018): built and maintained e-commerce for three fashion brands on Magento 2; prepared the platform for peak-load sales; acting team lead.
- **uCoz — Backend Developer (PHP)** (2015–2017): built the backend in a cross-functional team of 6; chose the stack (Laravel/Lumen).
- **A-Position — Web Developer** (2013–2014): built full-stack client sites; SQL optimization.

AI / LLM ENGINEERING

Native ad-segment detector + eval harness · Go, Anthropic API, OpenAI API

github.com/bayanovea/native-ad-skip-eval · github.com/bayanovea/native-ad-skip-api

Side project: my own browser extension, where viewers mark native ad segments in videos and others skip them; ~11k weekly active users, ~12.5k crowdsourced markups.

- Built the LLM detector and a public eval harness (a held-out set of 217 videos with human-reviewed labels). Result: 95% precision (what it cuts is real ad); about half of all ad time removed.
- Decisions by measurement: compared Opus, Sonnet and Haiku on the same labels; cut inference cost 3x (Batches API, prompt format) with no measurable quality change; a Grafana dashboard tracks the live funnel and cost per video.
- Built the production loop: viewer reactions (votes, overrides, new markups) trigger an automatic re-check that withdraws the segment or routes it to human review.

AI-assisted engineering · Claude Code, Codex

github.com/bayanovea/claude-setup · github.com/bayanovea/agent-loop-go

- Early user and adopter of coding agents on a backend team: daily agent-driven development, coached engineers on where agents fit and where they don't.
- Run a controlled workflow, not vibe coding: spec-driven development (OpenSpec), plan before build, cross-review of each change by several models with different prompts; own agent setup public: github.com/bayanovea/claude-setup (layered agent instructions, skills, hooks).
- Choose model, harness and effort per task; know where the tokens go: context budgeting, prompt caching, batch APIs.
- Understand the machinery under the hood: how agent loops and tool use work (studied, and built a small one in Go), how coding-agent harnesses are designed and where they differ; working knowledge of RAG, prompt-injection defenses and guardrails, and when fine-tuning beats prompting.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Go (main), PHP (11+ years), SQL; some experience with Python, JavaScript, Node.js.
- **AI / LLM:** Anthropic and OpenAI APIs (tool use, structured output, Batches API), prompt and context engineering, AI agents (agent loops, tool use), LLM evaluation: LLM-as-judge, eval harnesses (held-out sets, reviewed labels, run-to-run noise), staged rollout; Claude Code, Codex, Hermes; models: Claude, GPT, GLM, Kimi; agent instructions, skills, hooks, MCP (as a consumer); OpenSpec.
- **Data and infra:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, ClickHouse, Redis, Memcached, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Elasticsearch; gRPC, Kubernetes, Docker, GitLab CI, Grafana, Sentry.
- **Practices:** system and API design, high-traffic systems, A/B experiments, SLA/SLO/SLI, code review, hiring.

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

St. Petersburg State University, Specialist degree (5-year program) in Applied Mathematics and Informatics, 2014 · English: professional working proficiency · Russian: native